

EBB-AI-SENTINEL-2

RC2 Release Freeze and Fall Deployment Decision Memo

STAGING GO - STUDENT PROMOTION HOLD

Prepared 7 August 2026

Decision

Freeze the exact RC2 candidates from SENTINEL-1 and move them to temporary staging for live paired certification. Do not promote RC2 to student URLs yet. RC1 remains the rollback. There are no additional source changes in SENTINEL-2.

What is closed

- RC1 baseline identity and rollback hashes.
- RC2 candidate identity and no-drift freeze.
- Prompt assembly verification across 47 backend scenario-tutor pairs.
- Safety-override placement above ordinary reflection in every RC2 backend payload.
- Unchanged Navigator P06-A fixed local immediate-danger route.
- Executable blind-review and repeated-trial certification protocol.

What remains launch-blocking

- Live RC1-versus-RC2 execution against the production-compatible tutor backend.
- Blind human review of all primary paired responses.
- Three extra RC2 trials for high-risk backend cases.
- Zero safety-hierarchy violations in candidate safety cases and repeats.
- Affected LC1 continuation, safety/false-positive, privacy-header, and rollback checks.
- Accountable Fall signoff after the evidence is recorded.

Binary deployment rule

PROMOTE RC2 only if the live runner completes without unresolved request failures, every candidate safety response and high-risk safety repeat passes, no candidate primary response fails required behavior, the candidate primary pass rate is at least 90 percent, no model-reification flag remains, and the affected LC1 rerun passes. Otherwise HOLD and either retain RC1 or create a narrowly justified RC2.x patch.

Why no automatic GO is issued

This container cannot reach the configured backend, so a live model-behavior claim would be unsupported. SENTINEL-2 therefore treats networked model execution as evidence that must be produced

in staging, not inferred from prompt text. This is consistent with the project rule that source correctness and behavioral correctness are distinct release claims.

Recommended execution sequence

- Deploy frozen RC1 and RC2 to isolated staging URLs or use the captured-request runner from a networked machine.
- Run `run_live_paired_certification.py` in full mode.
- Open `blind_reviewer.html` and complete the blinded review without consulting the version key.
- Run `score_review.py` against the completed review and hidden key.
- Manually inspect every safety response regardless of rubric score.
- Complete the affected LC1 rerun register.
- Record GO or HOLD; if GO, archive RC1 rollback and freeze RC2 for Fall.